Myungsung Kim

Combined M.S./Ph.D. Candidate · Graduate School of Health Science and Technology, UNIST

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Ph.D. expected February 2027 · Alternative service as an expert researcher (Republic of Korea), March 2027 – February 2028 · Seeking industry or postdoctoral positions from March 2028.

RESEARCH VISION

Recent work in neuroscience and psychology has produced surprising findings about human emotion, intuition, and bias. I want to take that knowledge into healthcare, turn it into technology that people can actually use in their lives, and then rebuild what we know about the effects of that technology. Technology in healthcare has to serve two groups at the same time: the people who use it and the people who deliver it, most often clinicians. My doctoral research therefore splits into two questions. The first is how users are changed by an intervention, and the second is how providers come to accept that intervention. I lean on qualitative and mixed methods because I want to catch the complicated context of real settings. The insights I take from individual results are piling up in my head, and at some point I want to develop and demonstrate an integrated strategy for putting them to work in practice.

CURRENT RESEARCH

I am currently preparing for my doctoral defense and finishing two studies with practitioner samples. Both continue directly from the JMIR papers published this year, which makes them especially interesting to me, because the counseling center and the psychiatric clinic are precisely where this line of work has to land.

- A Delphi study with 20 counseling professionals on whether, and in what form, each digital intervention could be introduced into counseling practice.
- A comparative survey of psychiatrists (n=408) and General working adults (n=252) on their experiences with and perceptions of mental health AI chatbots.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles (First Author)

[1] Kim, M., An, Y., Jeon, M., Lee, Y., Lahcine, O. F., Kim, H., ... & Cho, C. H. (2026). Mapping Practice-Based Signals of Generative AI in Psychiatric Care: Qualitative Study of Korean Psychiatrists' Experiences, Interpretations, and Implementation Priorities. *Journal of Medical Internet Research, 28*, e96556.

[2] Kim, M., Kim, H., Heo, J. I., Lee, S., Lahcine, O. F., Lee, S., ... & Jung, D. (2026). Acceptability and Preliminary Evaluation of a Campus-Integrated Digital Platform (Fruto) for University Students' Mental Health Help-Seeking: Sequential Mixed Methods Study. *Journal of Medical Internet Research, 28*, e78930.

[3] Kim, M., Jeon, M., Lee, Y., Lee, Y., Yu, S., Lee, S., ... & Jung, D. (2026). Virtual reality exposure therapy with graded interviewer reactions for public speaking anxiety in university students: a randomized controlled trial protocol. *Trials, 27*(1), 485.

[4] Kim, M., Jeon, M., Lee, Y., Lee, S., Kim, H., & Jung, D. (2025). Exploring predictors of counselors' acceptance of virtual reality exposure therapy with resistance and job contexts as moderators: Cross-sectional mixed methods study. *Journal of Medical Internet Research, 27*, e81803.

[5] Kim, M., Lee, S., Kim, S., Heo, J. I., Lee, S., Shin, Y. B., ... & Jung, D. (2025). Therapeutic potential of social chatbots in alleviating loneliness and social anxiety: Quasi-experimental mixed methods study. *Journal of Medical Internet Research, 27*, e65589.

[6] Kim, M., Lee, S., Jeong, I. J., Jeon, M., & Jung, D. (2024). Digital interventions for mental health: Challenges and opportunities. *Journal of the Korean Medical Association, 67*(12), 752–761.

Journal Articles (Co-Author)

[7] Lee, S., Jeong, J., Kim, M., Lee, S., Kim, S.-P., & Jung, D. (2025). Effectiveness of a semigenerative chatbot–integrated to-do app for procrastination management: A randomized controlled trial. *JMIR mHealth and uHealth, 13*, e53133.

In this study I contributed to the thematic analysis of user experience data, coding and categorizing the features of the intervention.

[8] Lee, S., Lee, K., Lee, S., Lee, Y., Kim, M., & Jung, D. (2022). Categorization of potential classes using the university counseling center service application. *Journal of the Korean Neuropsychiatric Association, 61*(3), 170–177.

In this study I contributed to the initial statistical analysis and to the classification modeling.

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers

[9] Jeon, M., Kim, M., Lee, Y., Lee, S., Kim, H., & Jung, D. (2025). Why only in the lab? Understanding counselors' technology acceptance intentions on virtual reality exposure therapy: A mixed methods study. *CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*.

[10] Kim, H., Kim, M., Heo, J.-I., Lee, S., Kim, H., & Jung, D. (2025). Understanding university students' experiences on the multi-domain help-seeking platform "Fruto": A vignettes study. *CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*.

[11] Lee, J. H., Ham, H.-G., Kim, M.-S., & Bae, S.-H. (2020). 3D sketching for multi-pose products: An interactive showcase. *ACM SIGGRAPH 2020 Labs*.

[12] Kim, H., Kim, M., & Oakley, I. (2019). A mobility evaluation of tilt panning and offset sensing smart watch input. *Proceedings of the 5th ACM Workshop on Wearable Systems and Applications (WearSys '19)*.

FUNDED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Digital Phenotyping-Based Self-Distancing AI Agent for Mental Health — May 2026 – Dec 2026

Lead Graduate Researcher · PI: Prof. Dooyoung Jung · UNIST, Republic of Korea

- **Problem.** University students under-utilize professional help; passive digital signals may prompt earlier self-awareness.
- **Role & Method.** Leading intervention design, study planning, and manuscript preparation; integrating digital phenotyping with an LLM-based self-distancing agent.

Digital Therapy Contents for Anxiety through Psychiatry–Art Convergence — Jun 2022 – Dec 2026

Lead Graduate Researcher · PI: Prof. Dooyoung Jung · UNIST, Republic of Korea

- **Problem.** Public speaking anxiety is prevalent among university students but under-treated in campus settings.
- **Role & Method.** Led intervention and study design, VR content development, RCT protocol registration, and mixed methods evaluation with counselors.

UNIST Life Coaching Platform (Fruto) — Internal UNIST Project — Oct 2021 – Dec 2025

Lead Graduate Researcher · PI: Prof. Dooyoung Jung · UNIST, Republic of Korea

- **Problem.** Fragmented on-campus help resources and low help-seeking rates among students.
- **Role & Method.** Led help-seeking platform design, campus-integrated deployment, and a mixed-methods evaluation of student experience.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP

MindMILE — Chief Strategy Officer (CSO) — 2024 – Present

Mental health startup translating campus research into deployable products · Republic of Korea

- Co-lead product strategy, intervention design, and research-to-practice translation for college students and young adults.
- Bridge doctoral research (chatbots, VR, help-seeking platforms) with market-facing pilots and B2B partnerships.

Selected honors and programs (most recent first)

- Advanced to Main Round, GRAVITY 2026: National Inter-University Startup League of Korea's Four Science & Technology Institutes (UNIST, KAIST, GIST, DGIST) — 2026, ongoing.
- Special Award, 2026 Regional Startup Solve-a-thon Competition — 2026.
- Selected for TeX-Corps (Technology Entrepreneurship Exploration Program), Ministry of Science and ICT — 2025.
- Selected for the Pre-Startup Package, Ministry of SMEs and Startups / KISED — 2025.
- Outstanding Pre-Startup Team, INU Pre-Incubating Challenge, Incheon National University — 2024.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 · ISRII (Oral). Kim, M., et al. Clinicians' Experiences, Type-Specific Risk Perceptions, and Implementation Priorities for AI Chatbots in Mental Health Care: A Mixed-Methods Survey of Psychiatrists in South Korea.
- 2025 · CHI 2025 EA (Poster, LBW). Jeon, M., Kim, M., et al. Why Only in the Lab? Understanding Counselors' Technology Acceptance Intentions on VRET.
- 2025 · CHI 2025 EA (Poster, LBW). Kim, H., Kim, M., et al. Understanding University Students' Experiences on Multi-Domain Help-Seeking Platform “Fruto”: Vignettes Study.
- 2025 · ISRII (Oral). Kim, M., et al. Exploring the Psychological Well-Being Effects of Social Chatbots and External Factors Influencing Their Interactions.
- 2024 · ISRII (Poster). Kim, M., et al. Assessment of Mental Health Outcomes and User Feedback Following a 4-Week Social Chatbot Use by University Students.
- 2023 · WCCBT (Poster). Kim, M., et al. Interview & Semi-Role-Playing Observation of Counseling Center for Introduction of Digital Mental Care Services into the Counseling Process.
- 2023 · WCCBT (Poster). Kim, M., et al. Mobile Cognitive Therapy with Generative Disputation Using a Large-Scale Language Model.
- 2022 · ISRII (Poster). Kim, M., et al. Development of a Practical Chatbot System for Content Recommendation and Data Collection: The Case of UNIST Healthcare Center.

EDUCATION

Combined M.S./Ph.D., Health Science and Technology — Feb 2022 – Feb 2027

Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology (UNIST), Republic of Korea · Advisor: Prof. Dooyoung Jung (HAI Lab)

Doctoral research topic: Stepped Digital Care for College Student Social Adaptation — An Iterative Program of Refinement, Effectiveness, and Implementation Across Digital Modalities.

B.S., Human Factors Engineering — Feb 2015 – Feb 2019

UNIST, Republic of Korea · Graduated Cum Laude (GPA 3.79 / 4.30)

HONORS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Cum Laude, B.S. Graduation, UNIST — 2019.
- Encouragement Prize, National Business Idea Competition in Bio, Ministry of Science and ICT — 2018.
- Academic Excellence Scholarship, UNIST — 2015–2018 (4 consecutive years).
- National Science & Engineering Scholarship (Korea Student Aid Foundation) — 2017–2018.

MENTORING & OUTREACH

- Group Leader, UNIST E@U High School Mentoring Program — 2015, 2017, 2018.
- Mentor, Winter Science Gifted Mentoring Program — 2015.
- Mentor, Ulsan City Summer Dream Camp — 2016.
- UNIST Student Ambassador — 2015–2016.